Complaints and Feedback Policy

This policy sets out how anyone can raise a concern, complaint or piece of feedback about GPAK's work, across all of its programmes, and how GPAK responds. It works together with the Safeguarding and PSEA Policy (POL-01) and the Anti-Fraud, Bribery and Corruption Policy (POL-05).

1 Who can complain

- Participants and their caregivers.
- Community members, including people who are not participants.
- Partners, facilities and county representatives.
- GPAK staff, mentor mothers, community volunteers and Advisory Committee members.

2 What can be raised

- The quality, fairness or timeliness of support received.
- The conduct of a staff member, mentor mother, community volunteer or visitor.
- A safeguarding concern (handled under POL-01, not this policy: see section 6).
- Suspected fraud, bribery or misuse of funds (handled under POL-05 and POL-06).
- A decision about eligibility, closure or the amount or type of support provided.
- Any other concern about how GPAK carries out its work.

3 Channels

A complaint or piece of feedback can be raised through any of the following:

- In person at the GPAK office in Homa Bay Town.
- By phone: +254 725 737 867.
- By email: info@gpakgirls.org.
- Using a feedback card (Annex).
- To the Chair of the Advisory Committee, for a complaint about the Director.

4 A route that bypasses a participant's own mentor mother or case worker

Every participant is told, at enrolment and again at her progress review, that she does not have to raise a concern through her own mentor mother or case worker. All the channels in section 3 reach GPAK directly, without going through the person the complaint might be about, or someone close to them.

5 Anonymous complaints

A complaint may be made anonymously. GPAK will act on an anonymous complaint as far as the information provided allows, though it may not be possible to follow up for more detail or to report back on the outcome.

6 How complaints are handled

1. Log: every complaint is logged in the restricted complaints register (MEL-03), whether received in person, by phone, by email or by card.
2. Acknowledge: the complainant is acknowledged within 5 working days, unless the complaint is anonymous and no contact details were given.
3. Assess: the complaint is assessed to decide the right route. A safeguarding complaint goes straight to the Safeguarding Focal Point under POL-01. A complaint about suspected fraud, bribery or corruption goes to the route in POL-05 or POL-06.

4. Investigate: the complaint is investigated by someone not directly involved in the matter complained about.
5. Respond: the complainant receives a response within 30 days of the complaint being logged, including what was found and what, if anything, GPAK will do differently.
6. Appeal: a complainant who is not satisfied can appeal to the Director. Where the complaint is about the Director, the appeal goes to the Chair of the Advisory Committee.

7 Non-retaliation

Raising a complaint, in good faith, never reduces a participant's or a colleague's access to support, pay, role or standing at GPAK. Anyone who retaliates against a complainant is in breach of the Code of Conduct (POL-02).

8 Participant feedback beyond complaints

GPAK also collects feedback that is not a complaint, to learn and improve:

- A short feedback card given to every participant at enrolment (Annex).
- A participant-led progress review, held during her time in the programme.
- Feedback gathered at the end of each group session.

9 Learning

The Safeguarding Focal Point or the Director prepares a quarterly summary of complaints and feedback, without identifying details, for the Advisory Committee. Aggregate, anonymised findings are included in reporting to funders, as each grant agreement requires.

10 Record keeping

Every complaint and its outcome is kept in the restricted complaints register in MEL-03. Access is limited to the people handling the complaint and the Director.

Approval and review

Item	Detail
Policy owner	Director
Approved by	Advisory Committee
Applies to	All GPAK staff, Advisory Committee members, volunteers, mentor mothers, community volunteers, interns, consultants, contractors and partners working on GPAK activities
Review	Every two years, or earlier if the law, a funder requirement or an incident review shows that a change is needed.

Public copy. Internal forms, annexes and signature pages are kept on file by GPAK and are available on request.